- ‘Chicken is sold at a huge mark-up price by retailers. Before demonetization, the cost of chicken across Maharashtra ranged between ₹120 and ₹160 per kg. In the last few days, the prices have plunged to as low as ₹80–₹120 per kg across the state. The demand for chicken generally spikes in winters which leads to an increase in price. However, this time even retailers have been forced to sell at ₹70–₹80 per kg,’ said Nazim Sayyed, a poultry retailer in Mumbai.[20]
- Anju Thengue is a village in Kerala with a population of 16,732, out of which 8,475 are women. Sixty per cent of the women work in the fish trade. ‘One box of fish used to be auctioned for at least for ₹1,000, but now the box is not being auctioned even for ₹100,’ says Karmali, the official controller of the fish auctioning. Unsold fish are being dried and sold in packets and fisherwomen are trying to sell them on the Varkala-Kovalam beach road. But selling the packets is also not easy. ‘Instead of paying ₹100 for a dry fish packet, most of the buyers are giving ₹2,000 notes and seeking change.’
- The Mamballi Nedughadam Fishermen Society, situated at the centre of the village, is the apex agency of 160 women’s self-help groups comprising 3,000 fisherwomen. Most of them don’t have a bank account in any of the commercial banks. The scenes at the society office are turning ugly. One desperate fisherwoman vented her ire against the society authorities. ‘I have deposited my entire savings with the society,’ she said. ‘But I am not permitted to withdraw the amount. Please help me if you can.’ Says an office bearer: ‘According to the new regulations, even a cooperative society cannot withdraw more than ₹24,000 per week from a bank. We will only have ₹1 lakh to distribute amongst 3,000 women before Christmas. We are helpless.’[21]

Dairy and Milk Producers